

Four directions for the website

COMMISSIONED SAT 29 AUG 2026 · FOUR POSITIONS, NOT FOUR POLISHES

The site at site/ was read and judged super wordy and very canned AI looking. Four directions were built against that verdict, each as two working HTML pages and a written argument, each critiqued and revised before it got here. They are renders of real files, not mockups.

THE 2 × 2 THAT GENERATED THEM

	TYPOGRAPHY AND COMPOSITION	STRUCTURE AND BEHAVIOUR
ANCHORED Stays inside the sheet's law: IBM Plex, grayscale, three voices.	A The apparatus talks <i>Put back a datum you can point at and a named furniture set, and half the prose deletes itself with nothing lost.</i>	B Six rows and an end <i>A site for a product whose success is you closing the tab has to be finite, addressable, and visibly over.</i>
FREE Allowed to leave it, and has to say what that buys.	C The site supplies the pen <i>No reader will ever put a pen on a website, so the site supplies the pen: every colour on it is ink.</i>	D The page is a sheet <i>Stop describing the loop and do the half a static page can do. Hand the visitor a real sheet, then end.</i>

Which of these is the site?

The four disagree about what replaces the prose. Page 15 puts the bets side by side and states the question plainly.

How to read this

TWELVE PAGES OF DIRECTIONS, THEN ONE QUESTION

Each direction gets three pages: the landing page as rendered, the interior page as rendered, and its argument set as type. The renders are full pages at 1400px, reduced. Where a page ran too long for one column it is cut into columns that read left to right, and the cut is labelled.

These are four positions rather than four polishes. They were built to disagree, so the set is only useful if the disagreements stay visible. Averaging them produces a safe middle, which is the outcome the printed design sprint was explicitly instructed to avoid and the outcome this one is aimed away from too.

WHAT IS BEING ASKED OF YOU

Read the costs before the bets. Every argument page gives its cost section more room and a heavier rule than its bet, on purpose. A page that sells without costing is the rigged vote this format exists to prevent.

Judge the position, not the polish. All four were revised after a critique pass, so none of them is arguing from a defect you can point at. What is left to choose between is what each one believes a website for this product is for.

Two of them break rules the sheets enforce. C leaves grayscale and leaves IBM Plex. D moves the verify gate outside the machinery that owns it. Both name the break rather than hiding it. Whether the website is bound by the sheet's law is a decision only you can make.

A hybrid is allowed. The printed system is one. Take whole organs rather than splitting differences, which is the instruction that produced design.md.

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT IS SET IN

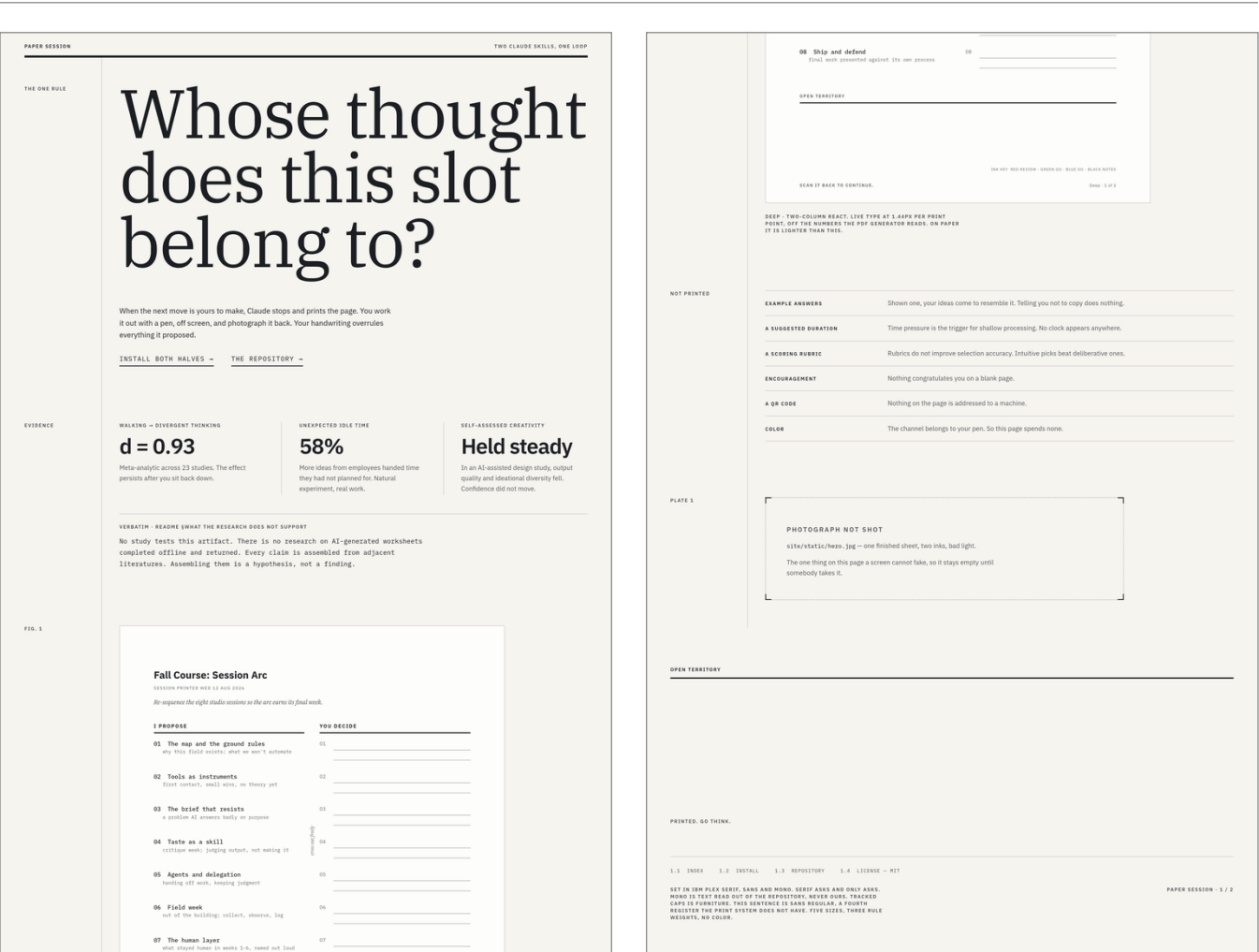
IBM Plex, grayscale, US Letter portrait at 54pt margins, verified by `verify_layout.py` like any sheet. Serif carries the propositions and the closing question. Mono is quoted material. Tracked Sans caps is furniture. The running prose is Plex Sans regular, which is a fourth register the printed system does not have and does not need, since it prints no prose. The plates are the exception. C and D use colour, and reproducing them in gray here would misreport them.

A · The apparatus talks

THE LANDING PAGE, AS RENDERED

Put back a datum you can point at and a named furniture set, and half the prose deletes itself with nothing lost.

Masthead, 5px datum, one 154px serif question against a rail. Fig. 1 is a whole Deep sheet in live HTML off the print spec.



A · The apparatus talks

THE INTERIOR PAGE, AS RENDERED

Put back a datum you can point at and a named furniture set, and half the prose deletes itself with nothing lost.

Install and the compatibility ledger. Four routes at equal weight, status terms defined above the table, a tally under the closing rule.

PAPER SESSION

INSTALL

2 / 2

Which of these is true of you?

Take both halves or neither. Every sheet prints SCAN IT BACK TO CONTINUE, along its bottom edge, and without the return half that line is a promise nothing keeps.

My AI is an app or a browser tab.

01 · TWO BUNDLES ↓

My AI runs in a terminal or my editor.

02 · ONE COMMAND ↓

A terminal, but no Node.

03 · CLONE AND UNZIP ↓

My AI cannot take skills at all.

04 · PASTE ONE FILE ↓

THE DIRECTIONS

01 · CHAT APP

`paper-session_skill`
`scan-back_skill`

Download both and upload them where your client takes skills. No terminal, no unzipping. The skill installs what it needs where it runs.

02 · TERMINAL OR IDE

`npm skills add welovejeff/paper-session`

Finds both skills in the repository and routes them to Claude Code, Cursor, Codex, Copilot and 70+ other agents. Project-level by default; -g installs user-level.

03 · NO NODE

`git clone https://github.com/welovejeff/paper-session.git`
`cd paper-session`
`unzip -o paper-session_skill -d ~/.claude/skills/`
`unzip -o scan-back_skill -d ~/.claude/skills/`

The bundles are ordinary zips. Whatever unpacks an archive on your machine is enough.

04 · NO SKILLS RUNTIME

`paper-session(paste.md)`
`scan-back(skill.md)`

Nothing installs, because nothing reads a skills folder. Paste the forward file, say what you are working on, and add the sentence in the box below. What comes back is a card you copy into a notebook by hand, never a PDF.

I can't print, and you can't make a PDF here, so dictate the setup card for me to copy by hand – there is nothing to annotate.

That sentence is load-bearing: it is what routes the host onto the setup-card path.

PYTHON

`python3 -m pip install -r ~/.claude/skills/paper-session/requirements.txt`

rsync(1) draws the page. pdf(1) never runs the layout gate no sheet is allowed to ship. Point pip at the copy that arrived with the skill. Add --break-system-packages where pip reports the environment is externally managed. Nothing to install on a chat surface; nothing at all on the paste route, which renders no file.

TERMS FIRST

`paper-session_skill`
`scan-back_skill`

SUPPORTED

The chat-native path the return trip was designed around. It stops short of a reported end-to-end run.

INSTALLS CLEANLY, LOOP UNTESTED

The install works. Nobody has carried a page all the way round on this agent. One session report closes the row.

UNTESTED, PER SURFACE

Nothing is rendered, so nothing is verified. A pasted protocol also has no authority over the host's system prompt.

The word is the whole status. Nothing here is color-coded, because roughly one reader in twelve would lose the ledger the moment it was.

YOUR AGENT

INSTALL

THE LOOP TODAY

ALSO INSTALL

Claude Code — CLI, IDE, web

`npm skills add, or clone and unzip`

VERIFIED END TO END

reportlab + pdftplumber, on the machine running the agent

claude.ai · Claude desktop · mobile

Upload the two .skill files

SUPPORTED

A phone photographing the pages is what the return trip was built around.

Nothing by hand. The skill installs what it needs where it runs

Cursor · Codex · Copilot · other CLI-routable agents

`npm skills add -- -a -agent>`

INSTALLS CLEANLY, LOOP UNTESTED

reportlab + pdftplumber, wherever that agent runs Python

Anything else that reads SKILL.md folders

Unzip a bundle into the agent's skills directory

INSTALLS CLEANLY, LOOP UNTESTED

reportlab + pdftplumber, wherever that agent runs Python

Chat AI with no skills runtime — ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot chat, Perplexity, Le Chat, DeepSeek, Grok, Poe

Paste paper-session(paste.md), then scan-back(skill.md)

UNTESTED, PER SURFACE

The forward half produces a hand-copied card, never a PDF. The bright lines hold only as far as the host chooses to hold them.

Nothing. No PDF is generated, so no library is needed

ROWS VERIFIED END TO END

1/5

OUTSIDE SESSION REPORTS ON FILE

0

Copilot appears twice on purpose, in two different products: the CLI-routable IDE agent in row three, the chat surface in row five.

OPEN TERRITORY

1.1 INDEX

1.2 INSTALL

1.3 REPOSITORY

1.4 LICENSE · MIT

SET IN LOW PLEX GOTH. SAME AND MONO. GOTH ASKE AND ONLY ASKE. MONO IS TEXT READ OUT OF THE REPOSITORY. NEVER USED. TRACKED CARDS TO FURNITURE. THIS SENTENCE IS HAND REGULAR. A FORTY REGISTER THE PRINT SYSTEM DOES NOT MAKE. FIVE SIZES. THREE RULE WEIGHTS, NO COLOR.

PAPER SESSION · 2 / 2

A · The apparatus talks

THE ARGUMENT

THE BET

The site has no grid and no apparatus, so its labels grew into sentences. Restore a datum you can point at and a named furniture set, and half the prose deletes itself with nothing lost.

THE MECHANISM

Five declared type steps and nothing off-scale. One vertical hairline runs the page, and every band is a rail label beside one object. Fig. 1 sets a complete Deep sheet in live HTML off the print spec's own numbers, carrying the committed specimen verbatim. The ledger defines its terms above the table and closes on a tally: rows verified end to end, 1 / 5. Outside session reports on file, 0.

WHAT IT GIVES UP

Warmth. Bureau at nearly 100 per cent, with no Basement voice and not one funny line. The printed system is a hybrid for a reason, and this is half of it.

One instrument, and a phone takes it away. Every effect is scale against a datum. At 420px the question is 50px, the rail is a caption, and Fig. 1 is a sideways scroll.

A second, ungated copy of the print spec. Fig. 1 restates design.md in CSS and nothing checks it. build.sh fails on coupling drift; nothing watches the website. It had already drifted in three places before it shipped.

A fourth register. The site's own sentences are Plex Sans regular. Declared in the colophon, still a rule the sheets do not break.

The middle. With no lead size, anything needing 120 words becomes a table or gets cut, and some of it should not have been.

The ledger got slower. Filter chips became five rows you have to read, on the one page whose job is getting somebody installed.

WHERE IT BREAKS

The pattern library. A rail and five steps carry a ledger of thirty rows and carry the body of one pattern badly. Thirty screens of undifferentiated Sans is the tax-document failure.

Emotionally heavy content. The serial disclosure kit is about professional setbacks. Scale is this direction's only gear and it is the wrong one there.

The unshot photograph. A real one lands in Plate 1 as the highest-contrast object on the page, and every composition decision above it needs re-weighing.

THE COPY POSITION

About 270 words on the landing page and 320 on the interior. Every claim is either verbatim repository text or a sentence somebody can be wrong about in public.

B · Six rows and an end

THE LANDING PAGE, AS RENDERED

A site for a product whose success is you closing the tab has to be finite, addressable, and visibly over.

The front door as an index. Six numbered first-person preconditions that are the table of contents and the router at once, on one screen, in 122 words.

PAPER SESSION SCREEN · PAPER · PEN · SCAN · SCREEN		INDEX
THE LOOP	Claude stops mid-task. You get a page. It picks up from your handwriting. VERBATIM · THE CLOSING MESSAGE Printed. Go think.	
WHERE YOU ARE	01 I can print.	GET A SHEET →
	02 I have no printer, or no way to read a printed page.	THE CARD PATH →
	03 I have marked-up paper already.	SCAN IT BACK →
	04 I want both halves wired into the agent I use.	INSTALL →
	05 My AI cannot install skills at all.	PASTE ONE FILE →
	06 I want to know where the evidence stops.	THE LIMITS →
SOURCE · MIT · IBM PLEX UNDER SIL OFL 1.1		INDEX · SIX PAGES

B · Six rows and an end

THE INTERIOR PAGE, AS RENDERED

A site for a product whose success is you closing the tab has to be finite, addressable, and visibly over.

Install as two folioed sheets. Two install tracks at equal column width, then the ledger and a tally that publishes the project's own worst number at display size.

PAPER SESSION

SCREEN · PAPER · PEN · SCAN · SCREEN

PAGE 04 OF 06

INSTALL · SHEET 1 OF 2

Install

Both halves or neither. Every sheet closes by naming the return half, so one without the other leaves a finished page with nowhere to go.

TWO TRACKS

TRACK A · CHAT APP OR BROWSER TAB

There is somewhere to attach a file and no terminal to type into.

VERBATIM · README \$INSTALL

paper-session.skill

scan-back.skill

Upload both wherever your client takes skills.

TRACK B · TERMINAL OR EDITOR

You have a shell.

VERBATIM · README \$INSTALL

npm skills add welovejeff/paper-session

NO NODE

unzip -o paper-session.skill -d ~/.claude/skills/

BOTH TRACKS

Two Python packages. One draws the sheet; the other refuses to let you see one that has not been checked. Whether you install them by hand depends on where your agent runs Python, never on which track you took.

VERBATIM · README \$INSTALL

python3 -m pip install -r ~/.claude/skills/paper-session/requirements.txt

Nothing by hand on a chat surface. The skill installs what it runs on.

PAPER SESSION · INSTALL

SHEET 1 OF 2

WHERE THE LOOP STANDS

Verified end to end means one person carried one page the whole way round on that agent: generated, printed, written on, photographed, and the work resumed from the handwriting. Exactly one row claims it.

AGENT

THE LOOP TODAY

ALSO INSTALL

Claude Code

CLI, IDE, web

VERIFIED END TO END

reportlab + pdfplumber, on the machine running the agent

claude.ai

desktop, mobile

SUPPORTED

Nothing by hand

Cursor, Codex, Copilot

and other CLI-routable agents

INSTALLS CLEANLY, LOOP UNTESTED

reportlab + pdfplumber, wherever that agent runs Python

Anything else that reads a SKILL.md folder

INSTALLS CLEANLY, LOOP UNTESTED

reportlab + pdfplumber, wherever that agent runs Python

Chat AI with no skills runtime

ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, Le Chat, DeepSeek, Grok, Poe

UNTESTED, PER SURFACE

Nothing: no PDF is rendered, so no library is needed

THE TALLY

1

OF FIVE ROWS CARRIED A PAGE ALL THE WAY ROUND

An untested row is a finding. Closing one takes one person and one session report from that agent.

INDEX · PAGE 04 OF 06

SHEET 2 OF 2 · END

RENDERED AT 1400 × 1800 CSS PX

B · Six rows and an end

THE ARGUMENT

THE BET

A website for a product whose success is you closing the tab has to be finite, addressable, and visibly over. Every page is one bounded screen: datum rule, closing rule, folio, and nothing after that.

THE MECHANISM

Four type sizes with a deliberate hole where a lead paragraph would get written. The front door is an index: six numbered first-person preconditions, each one click from its destination, 122 words on one screen. On Install, the rule that neither track may be favoured is enforced by column width rather than asserted. The ledger closes on a 5rem 1 beside OF FIVE ROWS CARRIED A PAGE ALL THE WAY ROUND.

WHAT IT GIVES UP

The door refuses to argue. $d = 0.93$, 58 per cent and confidence held steady all sit behind row 06. A reader who arrives cold and will not click gets thirteen words of Serif.

The 50 per cent law is demoted. Acreage becomes deference: no hero, no colour, no type louder than the sheet. The band above the closing rule is a tenth of the screen and is called .margin.

Growth stops at six rows. A seventh route means redesigning the front door rather than appending to it.

The folio over-claims. It publishes six pages and five do not exist yet. A five-page site with a six-page folio is worse than no folio, so this cannot ship half-built.

The behavioural budget is one gesture. On an axis named structure and behaviour, structure carries almost all of it, and the direction knows it is a defence rather than a rebuttal.

WHERE IT BREAKS

evidence.md as a page. Sixty citations do not divide into bounded screens. The folio either lies about arbitrary cuts or the page scrolls under a chassis whose whole claim is that pages end.

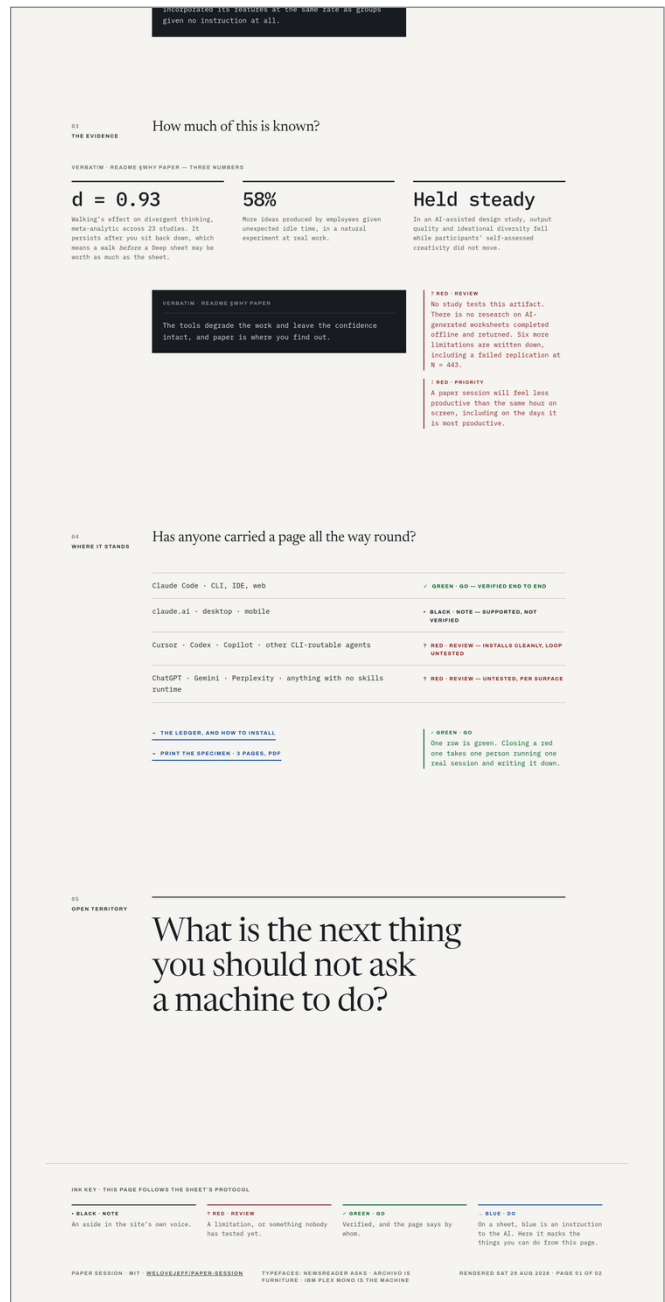
A third install track. Equal column width is honest only while there are two. Add the paste path and the layout claims a parity that path does not have.

A stranger. Routing by first-person statement works when the statements exhaust the audience. Somebody who fits none of the six has only the source link.

THE COPY POSITION

122 words on the index, 369 on Install, most of them ledger cells and shell commands. Flat on purpose: short and canned is still canned, and the alternative to marketing prose is a filing.

Six numbered sections in a rail, content and margin grid. The site's own opinions live only in the margin, written as pen marks in the sheet's own protocol.



C • The site supplies the pen

THE INTERIOR PAGE, AS RENDERED

No reader will ever put a pen on a website, so the site supplies the pen: every colour on it is ink.

Install. Three routes on dark machine plates at equal weight, status terms defined above the ledger, and one row of five in green with the page saying so.

PAPER SESSION

INSTALL - AND WHERE THE LOOP STANDS

DIRECTION C - PAGE 02 OF 02

ALL COLOUR BELOW IS INK - KEY AT THE FOOT

01
INSTALL

Where does your AI keep the things you give it?

VERBATIM - HEADLINE INSTALL

Get both halves, whatever your setup - they're a loop: paper-session prints "SCAN IT BACK TO CONTINUE." on every footer, and scan-back is what honors that promise.

02
THE ROUTES

Is there a file picker, a terminal, or only a text box?

A

CHAT APP

B

TERMINAL OR IDE

C

NO SKILLS RUNTIME

Can you attach a file to it?

Do you have a shell?

Only a text box?

VERBATIM - HEADLINE INSTALL

Download the two packaged bundles and upload them where your client takes skills. No terminal, no unscripting!
`paper-session_skill`
`scan-back_skill`
Nothing to install by hand on a chat surface, where the skill runs its own Python.

VERBATIM - HEADLINE INSTALL

The `skills CLI` finds both skills in this repo and routes them to Claude Code, Guttery Codes, Copilot, and 70+ other agents:
`npm skills add melowjeff/paper-session`
`COPY THE LINE`
Project-level by default; `-g` installs user-level. No Nuh? The bundles are ordinary files - clone and unzip into your skills directory.

VERBATIM - HEADLINE INSTALL

ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot chat, Perplexity, Le Chat, DeepSeek, Grok, Poe. There is nothing to install and one file to paste: `paper-session-paste.md`. Paste the whole file into the chat, say what you're working on, and add this sentence:
I can't print, and you can't make a PDF here, so dictate the setup and for me to copy by hand - there is nothing to annotate.

7 RED - REVIEW ON ROUTE C

A posted protocol is user text with no standing against the host's own system prompt. A model tuned to be maximally helpful can still pre-fill a zone or whatever a duration that the rules in the paste forbid. How often, on which product, is unmeasured.

03
THE WORDS IN THE LEDGER

What has to be true before a row gets its word?

✓ VERIFIED END TO END

Someone installed both halves on that agent, generated a sheet, printed it, filled it in with a pen, photographed the page, and had the work resumed from the photograph. One agent qualifies.

• SUPPORTED, NOT VERIFIED

The path the return trip was designed around, and where the skill installs what it needs on its own. No tested loop is claimed on it, so the ledger does not give it the same word.

7 INSTALLS CLEANLY LOOP UNTESTED

Discovery and install work. Whether that agent can run reportlab and read a photograph back afterwards is not known, because nobody has tried it and written it down.

7 UNTESTED, PER SURFACE

Nothing is rendered, so nothing is verified. The forward half produces a hand-copied card rather than a PDF, and there is no layout gate because there is no file. Each host is its own case.

04
THE LEDGER

Which of these has anyone finished?

WHERE THE LOOP STANDS. AGENT BY AGENT. NO ROW IS GRAYED UP.

AGENT	THE LOOP TODAY	ALSO INSTALL
Claude Code • CLI, IDE, web	✓ GREEN GO - VERIFIED END TO END Discovery, install, sheet generation, and scan-back all tested.	reportlab • pdfplumber, on the machine running the agent
Claude.ai • Claude desktop • mobile	• BLACK NOTE - SUPPORTED, NOT VERIFIED A phone photographing the pages is what the return trip was built around.	Nothing by hand - the skill installs what it needs where it runs
Cursor • Codex • Copilot • other CLI-routable agents	7 RED REVIEW - INSTALLS CLEANLY LOOP UNTESTED A session report from one of these is the contribution noted next.	reportlab • pdfplumber, wherever that agent runs Python

Anything else that reads SKILL.md folders

7 RED REVIEW - INSTALLS CLEANLY LOOP UNTESTED
Download a bundle, unzip it into the agent's skills directory.

reportlab • pdfplumber, wherever that agent runs Python

Chat AI with no skills runtime - ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot chat, Perplexity, Le Chat, DeepSeek, Grok, Poe

7 RED REVIEW - UNTESTED, PER SURFACE
The card is copied by hand into whatever notebook you already own.

Nothing - no PDF is generated, so no library is needed

05
PYTHON

Who draws the page, and who checks the drawing?

VERBATIM - HEADLINE INSTALL

reportlab draws the sheet; pdfplumber runs `verify_layout.py`, the layout gate no sheet is allowed to skip. The list ships inside the bundle, so point pip at the copy that arrived with the skill rather than at this repo:
`python3 -m pip install -r ~/claude/skills/paper-session/requirements.txt`
`COPY THE LINE`

• BLACK NOTE

Add `--break-system-packages` where pip reports the environment is externally managed.

06
BEFORE YOU INSTALL ANYTHING

Would you rather just hold one first?

• PRINT THE SPECIMEN • 3 PAGES, PDF

• BACK TO PAGE 01

• BLUE DO

These pages the generator built from a numeric spec and put through its own layout verifier.

07
OPEN TERRITORY

Which row are you going to close?

INK KEY: THIS PAGE FOLLOWS THE SHEET'S PROTOCOL

• BLACK NOTE
An aside in the site's own voice.

7 RED REVIEW
A limitation, or something nobody has tested yet.

• GREEN GO
Verified, and the page says by whom.

• BLUE DO
On a sheet, blue is an instruction to the AI. Here it marks the things you can do from this page.

PAPER SESSION • MIT • MELOWJEFF/PAPER-SESSION

INSTALL DIRECTIONS LIVE IN HEADLINE INSTALL AND ARE QUOTED HERE, NEVER REPEATED

RENDERED SAT 29 AUG 2026 • PAGE 02 OF 02 • END

C · The site supplies the pen

THE ARGUMENT

THE BET

The sheet is grayscale so the pen can be the loudest thing on it, and no reader will ever put a pen on a website. So the site supplies the pen: every colour on it is ink, and its own opinions are margin notes in the sheet's own protocol.

THE MECHANISM

Two of three faces change. Newsreader asks, Archivo is furniture, and Plex Mono stays, because the machine's words are the same words in both places. Four inks at identical lightness and chroma, hue the only variable. Repository text sits on a dark plate with its source named and nothing glossing it. The landing page carries the same sheet twice: printed, and returned.

WHAT IT GIVES UP

It is louder than the product. A dark plate and three saturated inks is more visual event than design.md permits anywhere. A visitor sold by this page prints something quieter.

The container leaks where the content is hardest. The ledger's definitions and cells are 278 words of ordinary explanatory prose, more than every margin note on both pages combined.

It teaches a protocol nobody asked to learn. The colour means nothing until the ink key is read, and the ink key is in the footer.

No exit for 4,000 pixels. Open territory closes the page, so the links close it too. There is no navigation until section 04.

The shared identity goes. Somebody who loves the sheet meets a stranger, set in two faces the repository does not own.

The returned specimen is cleaner than any real one. When the photograph is finally shot, the drawing will look better than the truth.

The margin is a desktop device. Below 1024px the grid collapses and the layout stops enforcing the cap on the site's voice.

WHERE IT BREAKS

The limitations page. Six items needing real nuance, where the site's voice is a three-sentence note, and a page whose every mark is red reads as an error state.

The pattern library. A page that is nothing but content, under a mechanism built to keep content out of the site's voice.

Anyone printing the website. Dark plates, on a site about printing. The only defence is a print stylesheet nobody has written.

THE COPY POSITION

The site may ask and annotate. It may not explain. 158 words of margin notes on the landing page. No study tests this artifact is a red mark, in the ink the product tells you to use for exactly that.

D · The page is a sheet

THE LANDING PAGE, AS RENDERED

Stop describing the loop and do the half a static page can do. Hand the visitor a real sheet, then end.

The sheet on the front door is in the DOM at Letter proportions. Two radios switch it between knowing nothing about you and having done work. Ctrl+P produces the artifact.

PAPER SESSION01 / 02

What are you agreeing with because arguing takes longer?

THIS PAGE IS A SHEET.

01

01 THE SHEET

01 KNOWING NOTHING ABOUT YOU

02 HAVING DONE WORK

The thing you keep not deciding

DECISION PROBABLY NOT 100% MADE GOOD

INTEREST — FOR EXPERIMENT WORKING THE PAGE UP YOUR

PRINT THESE ARE PAGES

The obvious answers. Write them down so they stop taking up room.

01

02

03

USE PREOCCUPATION

Name the decision you have been describing instead of making

Just do research. The decision.

OPEN TERRITORY

HERE IS BACK TO CONTINUING

ABOUT 100 Y

IF YOU CAN PRINT

Letter, grayscale, margins already correct.

PRINT THIS PAGE.

IF YOU CANNOT

Six lines into the notebook on your desk: the title, the box, the three rules, the question. Leave the rest of the paper alone.

WHAT DECIDES WHICH OF THE TWO

A website has read none of your work, so state 01 proposes nothing. The installed skill is the half that has read it.

INSTALL BOTH HALVES

02 WHEN YOU COME BACK

"scan-back is one markdown file with nothing behind it — no scripts, no Python, no Swift, no second document to fetch — so it justifies into a single chat message anywhere text goes."

README & INSTALL, VERBATIM

github.com/mlive/jeff/paper-session/scan-back/README.md

COPY THE LINK

PASTE IT. ADD THE PHOTOS. SAY NOTHING ELSE.

03 THREE NUMBERS

WALKING, DIVERGENT THINKING

d = 0.93

Meta-analytic across 23 studies. It persists after you sit back down.

UNEXPECTED IDLE TIME

58%

More ideas from employees given it, in a natural experiment at real work.

AI-ASSISTED DESIGN STUDY

Confidence held steady

Original quality and rhetorical diversity fell. Self-assessed creativity did not move.

04 WHERE THE LOOP STAYS

VERIFIED: END TO END

One person carried a real session through every step: install, generation, printing, pen, photograph, resume.

SUPPORTED

The workflow the return trip was built around. Straker then verified: no single run has been written up.

INSTALLS CLEANLY, LOOP UNTESTED

The first half of that sentence and none of the second.

UNTESTED, PER SURFACE

Nobody has checked, and the answer may differ by product.

AGENT

STATUS

WHAT THAT LEAVES

Claude Code

VERIFIED: END TO END

Needs reportlab and pdfplumber on the machine running the agent.

claude.ai, desktop, mobile

SUPPORTED

The chat-native path. A phone photographing the pages is what the return trip was built around.

Cursor, Codes, Copilot

INSTALLS CLEANLY, LOOP UNTESTED

A session report from one of these is the contribution wanted most.

ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, Gink

UNTESTED, PER SURFACE

No skills routine, so no PDF and no verify gains. You copy a dictated card by hand.

OPEN TERRITORY

02 / 0202 THE RETURN TRIP →

RENDERED AT 1400 × 3421 CSS PX

PAPER SESSION · SITE DIRECTIONS · SAT 29 AUG 2026

12 OF 15

D · The page is a sheet

THE INTERIOR PAGE, AS RENDERED

Stop describing the loop and do the half a static page can do. Hand the visitor a real sheet, then end.

The return trip, chosen because it is the half of the loop that already works today on paper the visitor has. It is also the one page colour is permitted on.

PAPER SESSION02 / 02

Where your pen contradicts the machine, which one is right?

"Your handwriting wins. Where your pen contradicts what the AI guessed easier, the pen is right, silently and completely. No reflagging, no gentle pushback on a judgment you already settled."

README § USING IT, VERBATIM

05THE ONE FILE

github.com/wlovesjeff/paper-session/zam/main/scan-back/SKILL.md

COPY THE LINK

01

Open the chat the photographs are going to land in.

02

Paste the file. Nothing else in that message.

03

Send the photographs with no message at all.

Paste it when the pages land, not before. A host holding transcription instructions for pages that do not exist yet will narrate the return trip, or invent its contents.

06THE PEN

INK — AMPLIFIES

■ Black

Notes, content, general text. The default voice.

■ Red

Needs review, stop, delete, push back on this.

■ Green

Approved, yes, move forward.

■ Blue

An instruction to the AI: do this on return.

MARK — CARRIES

strikethrough

Kill it. A considered rejection, not an absence.

circle

Elevate it. This matters.

?

Explain or expand this on return.

!

Priority.

star

Worth keeping beyond this task.

—

Sequence or causation. This leads to that.

@name

Route it to a person, tool, or system.

TLDR:

Treat this line as the zone's headline answer.

The mark is the carrier and the hue is the amplifier, so a page done in one black haltpoint is the primary case rather than the fallback. Write a legend anywhere on the paper and it outranks all of this for the session.

07IF THE CHAT IS COLD

"The chat holds no memory of the session, so it reconstructs from what the sheet itself prints — title, date, intent line, footer numbering — and spends its one re-anchoring question there. The pages are the whole record."

README § INSTALL, VERBATIM

This is why the sheets carry no QR code, no session ID, and no machine-readable block: nothing printed on them is addressed to a machine that was already in the room.

08WHAT THE RESEARCH DOES NOT SUPPORT

FILED AS OF 29 AUG 2026 · REFERENCE/EVIDENCE.MD

1

No study tests this artifact

There is no research on AI-generated worksheets completed offline and returned. Every claim is assembled from adjacent literatures.

2

Mind-wandering is contested

As the mechanism, including a well-powered failed replication at N = 443.

3

Handwriting recall is oversold

The encoding evidence is good. Simple recall superiority is not established.

4

Screen inferiority is conditional

It disappears when the stakes already force depth, and a tablet closes part of the gap.

5

Mostly undergraduates in labs

Ecological validity is a limitation the researchers themselves flag.

6

The AI-harm side is correlational

Nearly all of it.

A paper session will feel less productive than the same hour on screen, including on the day it is most productive.

OPEN TERRITORY

02 / 02 · END

RENDERED AT 1400 × 2971 CSS PX

PAPER SESSION · SITE DIRECTIONS · SAT 29 AUG 2026

13 OF 15

D · The page is a sheet

THE ARGUMENT

THE BET

Stop describing the loop and complete the half a static page is capable of. Hand the visitor a real sheet for the paper already on their desk, put the sheet that withholds and the sheet that proposes under one switch, and then end.

THE MECHANISM

The sheet is in the DOM at Letter proportions, with a print stylesheet set to design.md's numbers: 54pt margins, 2pt datum, 108pt open-territory floor. Both states print as a single 612 by 792 page and both pass verify_layout.py. Two radios and no JavaScript: state 01 knows nothing about you, state 02 puts five of the project's own claims in an I PROPOSE column against an empty YOU DECIDE. Printing ends the document.

WHAT IT GIVES UP

The verify gate ran by hand. Twice, in one engine, on content that never changes. Firefox and Safari lay the same CSS out differently and nothing checks them.

The stop fires on a cancelled dialogue. afterprint arrives whether the sheet printed or the visitor pressed Escape. A platform ambiguity built on, not a stance.

The machine's column argues about the wrong subject. The only work this website has honestly done is its own argument, so I PROPOSE proposes claims about paper-session.

A switch has to be noticed. State 01 is the default, and the whole correction rides on one pair of small tracked-caps labels.

Below 620px the sheet stops being Letter. It drops the aspect ratio to stay legible, so a phone never sees the proportions the argument rests on.

Room for two pages. The pattern library, the named formats and the research process have nowhere to go, and Serif restricted to questions leaves no long-form register.

The faces come from a CDN. The repository ships Plex locally; these pages load it from Google Fonts and degrade silently when that is blocked.

WHERE IT BREAKS

The pattern library. Twenty-odd patterns with evidence clusters is a document. Rendered here it becomes a list of names.

The group formats. Brainwriting rounds is one page pattern printed six times, and a site built around here is your one sheet cannot express a kit.

A phone visitor with no printer and no notebook. Both verbs resolve to paper, and the page has nothing else to offer them but a link out.

THE COPY POSITION

411 words in the site's own voice across both pages, counted the least flattering way, against 25,848 across the seven pages it replaces. Mono carries the propositions, because a reader is invited to strike those out.

The four bets, and the question

ALL FOUR DELETE THE PROSE · THEY DISAGREE ABOUT WHAT REPLACES IT

A The apparatus talks

ANCHORED × TYPOGRAPHY AND COMPOSITION

Put back a datum you can point at and a named furniture set, and half the prose deletes itself with nothing lost.

Replaces prose with apparatus. A grid, a figure, a table, a tally.

Costs most: warmth, and a phone, which takes its only instrument away.

B Six rows and an end

ANCHORED × STRUCTURE AND BEHAVIOUR

A site for a product whose success is you closing the tab has to be finite, addressable, and visibly over.

Replaces prose with an index that routes and refuses to argue.

Costs most: persuasion. The evidence is behind a click.

C The site supplies the pen

FREE × TYPOGRAPHY AND COMPOSITION

No reader will ever put a pen on a website, so the site supplies the pen: every colour on it is ink.

Replaces prose with the pen. The site annotates its own claims.

Costs most: the shared identity, and a claim it has no ink to make.

D The page is a sheet

FREE × STRUCTURE AND BEHAVIOUR

Stop describing the loop and do the half a static page can do. Hand the visitor a real sheet, then end.

Replaces prose with the artifact. The page is a sheet you print.

Costs most: the gate, which here ran by hand in one browser.

WHAT ALL FOUR AGREE ON

No hero paragraph, no chip filter, no call to action above the fold, and no upgraded compatibility claim. All four print the ledger with its terms defined above the table. And all four name the pattern library as the page they cannot carry, which is the strongest shared finding in the set: whatever wins here still owes that page a home.

THE QUESTION

How much is the website allowed to be the thing, rather than argue for it?

A and B argue for it from inside the sheet's law. C and D leave that law to get closer to the artifact, and each says what the trip cost. Answering the question picks a direction. Refusing it picks a hybrid, and the hybrid is only worth having if it takes whole organs.